

"I am a citizen of the world."

DIOGENES, GREEK PHILOSOPHER, c. 400–325 BCE

200 CE

c. 200
Peak of trade between India, China, and Rome. Korea free of Han—Koguryo, Silla, and Paekche states appear. Teotihuacán largest city in Americas; rise of Maya city of Tikal. Hopewell moundbuilding culture in North America.



◀ Sassanid Persian plate

224
Parthian Empire falls to Ardashir I, who founds Sassanid Persian dynasty.

235
Raids by Germanic Alemanni league on Rome's Black Forest and Rhine frontiers.

c. 250
Lodestone compass invented in China. Start of Classic Period of Maya civilization.
269–72
Queen Zenobia of Palmyra takes Egypt and Syria from Rome, but defeated and taken prisoner by emperor Aurelian.

280
China reunited under Jin dynasty.

292
Maya calendar in use, Tikal. Diocletian divides Roman Empire into Eastern and Western halves.

◀ Chinese paper

219
Hebrew edition of *Mishna*—sayings and teachings from the Torah.

c. 220
Han Dynasty collapses; replaced by three kingdoms: Shu, Wu, and Wei.

Kushan sculpture ▶



300 CE



▲ Roman Samian ware

c. 300
Armenia adopts Christianity. Kama Sutra written in India. Yamato state emerges in Japan. Bantu begin cattle herding in southeast Africa. Axum (Ethiopia) issues coins. Polynesian people settle remote Easter Island in Pacific.

Battle of Milvian Bridge outside Rome ▶



304
Xiongnu invade China. Christians persecuted in Rome by Diocletian.
312–13
Constantine wins Battle of Milvian Bridge and confirms religious freedom for Christians with Edict of Milan.

320
Gupta Dynasty of India heralds "Golden Age."

330
Byzantium made imperial Eastern Roman capital.

c. 350
White Huns invade India. Stirrup invented in China.



370
White Huns move west from Central Asia; defeat Ostrogoths in Ukraine.
370–415
Chandragupta's rule represents peak of Gupta dynasty.
378
Visigoths defeat Romans.

400 CE

c. 400
Population of Teotihuacán, Mexico reaches 250,000.

404
Translation of Bible into Latin completed.

410
Visigoths under Alaric sack Rome.



▲ Hun coins



▲ Attila the Hun

420
Liu Yu is first Liu Song emperor of China.

439
Vandals take Carthage from Rome, establish North African kingdom.

452
Huns invade Italy under Attila.



▲ Gupta buddha

478
First Shinto shrine in Japan.
479
Qi dynasty begins in southern China.
480
White Huns overthrow Gupta empire of India.
481
Accession of first Frankish king, Clovis I.



◀ Frankish ax

492
Ostrogoths under Theodoric conquer Italy.

500 CE



c. 500
Clovis converts to Christianity. Angles, Saxons, and Jutes migrate to Britain; Celts survive in Wales and Ireland. Camel trains cross Sahara from Ghana to North Africa.

Cave fresco, China ▶



595
Decimal system devised in India.
597
Papal mission to England under St. Augustine.
598
Byzantium concedes much of Italy to the Lombards.



Irish brooch ▲

500s
Apogee of Early Classic Maya civilization.
527
Justinian becomes Byzantine (Eastern Roman) Emperor.
534
Codex Justinianus codifies Roman law.

Maya relief ▶

